10 SWAPS, AND WHAT TO DO IF YOUR MANAGER IS SKEPTICAL

What to Do When Your Company Goes AI-First

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1 Pick one task to automate first

Pick a task you repeat every week.

> EXAMPLE
>
> **Don't say:** "I'll wait for the training."
> **Instead say:** "I'm going to try AI on my weekly status report this week."
>
> **Don't say:** "I don't know where to start."
> **Instead say:** "Starting with the Monday task that takes me two hours."

Pick a task you repeat every week.

2 Time it before and after

Write down how long it took before AI and after.

> EXAMPLE
>
> **Don't say:** "It feels faster."
> **Instead say:** "The report took 2 hours. With AI it took 30 minutes."
>
> **Don't say:** "I think it helps."
> **Instead say:** "Saved about 3 hours this week. I'm tracking it in a note."

Write down the before and after times.

3 Check the output before it goes anywhere

You still own every word you send.

> EXAMPLE
>
> **Don't say:** "AI wrote it, so it's fine."
> **Instead say:** "AI drafted it. I checked every number before sending."
>
> **Don't say:** "I just copy-pasted it."
> **Instead say:** "I used AI for the first draft and rewrote the summary myself."

You still own every word you send.

4 Share what worked with your team

Show the team your setup.

> EXAMPLE
> **Don't say:** "I'm keeping my tricks to myself."
> **Instead say:** "Here's the prompt I use for status reports. Saves me an hour."
> **Don't say:** "Everyone should figure it out."
> **Instead say:** "Can I show the team my setup in 10 minutes on Friday?"

The first person to share it usually gets asked to lead it.

5 Tell your manager the result

Say the hours saved and what you'd try next.

> EXAMPLE
> **Don't say:** "I've been playing with AI."
> **Instead say:** "AI cut my reporting time from 2 hours to 30 minutes. I'd like to try it on QA next."
> **Don't say:** "Still experimenting."
> **Instead say:** "One result so far: 3 hours a week saved on reports."

Say the hours saved and what you'd try next.

6 If your manager is skeptical

Ask for a small test with an end date.

> EXAMPLE
> **Don't say:** "Fine, I'll stop."
> **Instead say:** "Fair. Can I run it on one report for two weeks and show you the numbers?"

Ask for a small, timed test.

Check this week

Run this this week:

- [ ] Did you pick one weekly task?
- [ ] Did you time it before and after?
- [ ] Did you check the output?
- [ ] Did you share it with the team?
- [ ] Did your manager hear the result?